

REFORM DEMOCRATS OF THE NEW COMMONWEALTH

Scoring Justification Record — Section A

Phase I Proposals (37 proposals) — Foundation (0-5 Years)

REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026_SectionA — Framework v26 — Scoring Methodology v1.1 — Source Reference Guide v11 — Internal Reference — Not for Distribution

Score formula: **(GP + UT + B) / 1.5** — GP = Global Precedent (1-5) — UT = US Transition Difficulty (1-5: 5 = Minimal, 1 = Extreme) — B = Societal Benefit (1-5) — Source citations reference
REF_RDNC_SourceReferenceGuide_2026_11

[v26 revision] marks proposals where scores changed in Framework v26. Revision notes state what changed, why, and axis reassignment logic.

ECONOMY & TAX REFORM

P1 — IRS Reform & Pre-Filed Taxes

GP=5 · UT=4 · B=4 · Score: **8.7** · Phase I · Bill 1 — COLT Act Title I

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Pre-filled returns standard in 85%+ of OECD administrations; 10+ Tier 1 nations with documented high-compliance, high-satisfaction outcomes; IRS Direct File pilot (296,531 users, 94% satisfaction) validates US feasibility.

Sources: 1, 2, 8

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

Reconciliation vehicle (Bill 1); IRS demonstrated capacity via \$80B IRA appropriation; Direct File pilot confirmed scope, cost, and schedule targets; 2-3 year national rollout timeline with no structural barrier.

Sources: 2, 8, 196

B [4/5 — High]

~150M filing households benefit; \$31.7B/yr in commercial prep costs eliminated; burden relief most progressive for lower-income filers (highest share of income spent on tax prep); enforcement ROI \$3.18-\$12 per \$1 invested.

Sources: 3, 5, 6, 7, 37

P2 — Antitrust Enforcement & Corporate Accountability

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: **7.3** · Phase I · Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title III

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Over 75% of US industries increased concentration over 20 years; EU DMA (2022) and German GWB §19a demonstrate structural remedy frameworks with documented deterrence; criminal executive liability for repeat violators has documented behavioral-change effect in European enforcement.

Sources: 64, 65, 66, 67

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

60-vote Senate threshold applies to statutory criminal liability; executive enforcement posture (FTC/DOJ) can begin immediately; American Innovation and Choice Online Act (2022) stalled in Senate demonstrating political headwinds; 5-8 year timeline to structural market change.

Sources: 66, 196

B [4/5 — High]

Anticompetitive markups cost workers \$1.4T annually in suppressed wages; consumers bear \$1.4T+ in excess rents across concentrated sectors; distributional impact progressive (lower-income households spend higher share of income in concentrated markets).

Sources: 67, 68, 69

P3 — Ban Waste Export

GP=4 · UT=4 · B=3 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Executive — EPA rulemaking

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Basel Convention Amendment (2019, 187 parties) prohibits OECD-to-non-OECD hazardous waste export; EU, UK, and Canada enforce domestic processing mandates; China's National Sword policy (2018) documented global market impact.

Sources: 196

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

EPA statutory authority under RCRA provides implementation vehicle without new legislation; export restrictions on hazardous waste already in force; 3–5 year domestic infrastructure buildout is primary constraint; synergy with Bill 2/IIC capital investment.

Sources: 195

B [3/5 — Moderate]

Environmental benefit primarily accrues to export-destination nations (Indonesia, Malaysia, Vietnam); domestic geographic concentration of benefit near processing facilities; domestic job creation in waste processing sectors documented.

Sources: 162

HEALTHCARE & SOCIAL PROGRAMS

P8 — Restore Public Health Infrastructure & Biomedical Accountability

GP=5 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.7 · Phase I · Executive — HHS/CDC hybrid (Day 1 exec + Phase I legislation)

GP [5/5 — Proven]

UK NICE, Germany RKI, France Santé Publique France, Australia ATAGI all operate with statutory independence and multi-year funding stability; OECD documents consistent correlation between infrastructure investment and population outcomes; US CDC was global leader through mid-2010s.

Sources: 39, 192

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Day 1 executive component (funding restoration, ACIP independence) requires no congressional action; legislative components (mandatory CDC Director confirmation, vaccination standards) require Phase I legislation; 1–3 year timeline to operational restoration; Yale Budget Lab documents \$600B deficit impact of IRS defunding — same root cause documented for CDC.

Sources: 5, 54, 195

B [5/5 — Critical]

COVID-19 demonstrated the population-wide cost of infrastructure deterioration: CDC test failure (Feb 2020) attributable to budget cuts contributed to pandemic spread costing hundreds of thousands of lives; measles outbreak (4,000+ cases since Jan 2025, three deaths; CDC, 2026) is the current consequence of ACIP authority erosion; public health workforce shortfall ~80,000.

Sources: 39, 40, 54, 192

DEMOCRACY & ELECTORAL REFORM

P16 — Address Gerrymandering

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Bill 11 — DIR Act Phase III Title V

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Australia Electoral Commission, Canada provincial boundary commissions, UK Boundary Commissions, and New Zealand Representation Commission all remove partisan control from districting; Arizona AIRC and California IIRC demonstrate US state-level feasibility; AIRC upheld in Arizona State Legislature v. AIRC (2015).

Sources: 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Federal authority under Elections Clause (Art. I §4) for congressional elections is constitutionally established; Callais (3d Cir., April 2026) reinterpreted VRA §2 to require intentional discrimination proof, complicating enforcement but not Elections Clause authority; 30+ state transition requires either legislative compliance or

federal enforcement; one redistricting cycle (2–3 years) for meaningful impact.

Sources: 196, 197

B [5/5 — Critical]

Competitive districts structurally increase constituent responsiveness; local newspaper closure studies (Rubado-Jennings 2020) document lower turnout and higher corruption in uncompetitive districts; every other ARA proposal's durability depends on Congress that faces real electoral accountability; distributional impact universal.

Sources: 197

P17 — National Voting Holiday

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=3 · Score: **6.7** · Phase I · Bill 1 — COLT Act Title IV

v26 revision: UT: 4 -> 3 (Farber 2009 finding: near-zero turnout effect reassigned to B axis). B: 4 -> 3. Score: 7.3 -> 6.7.

GP [4/5 — Strong]

France, New Zealand, Australia designate election days as public holidays or hold elections on Sundays; OECD turnout data shows higher baseline participation in nations with weekend or holiday voting; 10+ Tier 1 comparators with documented structure.

Sources: 196, 197

[v26] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Achievable via simple majority legislation or executive proclamation — no structural barrier to enactment; but Audit 5 research found that federal holiday designation alone does not reach the 60–90% population affected threshold within 10 years because workers in retail, service, and healthcare (highest-turnout-suppression sectors) are least likely to observe the holiday.

Sources: 196

[v26] B [3/5 — Moderate]

Farber (2009, Princeton) found approximately zero statistically significant effect on voter turnout from Election Day federal holiday designation; policy retains real value as civic signal and marginal scheduling improvement for some workers, but the primary claimed mechanism (turnout increase) is not supported by Tier A evidence.

Sources: 196

P18 — Shutdown Accountability for Congress

GP=2 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: **6.0** · Phase I · Executive — House/Senate rules change

GP [2/5 — Limited]

No Tier 1 comparator experiences government shutdowns as a routine legislative mechanism; parliamentary systems resolve budget standoffs through confidence votes, mandatory continuing resolutions (Germany, Australia), or automatic temporary spending authority; principle (legislators bear cost of failure) is universal but mechanism is US-specific structural outlier.

Sources: 196, 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

27th Amendment constraints on pay reduction require prospective compensation forfeiture rather than retroactive reduction; House and Senate rules changes achievable by majority vote without presidential signature; primary political difficulty: the majority that changes the rules benefits from shutdown threats.

Sources: 196

B [4/5 — High]

2018–2019 35-day shutdown: \$11B direct economic cost (OMB); 800,000+ workers affected; federal contractor harm and long-term recruitment damage documented; shutdown normalization degrades federal workforce capacity and public trust in government functioning.

Sources: 195

P19 — Restore Independent Local News & Media Ownership Standards

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: **8.0** · Phase I · Executive — FCC rulemaking + CPB funding restoration

GP [4/5 — Strong]

BBC (UK), CBC (Canada), ABC (Australia), ARD/ZDF (Germany), NRK (Norway) demonstrate well-documented public media models; EU Media Freedom Act (2024) establishes ownership concentration limits; FCC broadcast

ownership caps (1975–2003) represent prior US domestic standard — restoration is reversion, not novelty.

Sources: 196, 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

FCC rulemaking to reinstate ownership caps is within existing statutory authority; CPB funding restoration (~\$500M/yr) achievable through reconciliation; structural editorial separation requirements face First Amendment challenge but commercial speech and broadcast licensing frameworks provide footing; 3–5 year timeline for market structural change.

Sources: 195, 196

B [5/5 — Critical]

Northwestern Local News Initiative: 2,500+ newspapers closed since 2005; Rubado-Jennings (Political Research Quarterly, 2020): local newspaper closure associated with lower voter turnout, higher corruption; Gao et al. (Journal of Finance, 2020): municipal borrowing costs increase after local newspaper closure; democratic accountability infrastructure is at stake.

Sources: 196

LEGAL & GOVERNANCE

P22 — Citizen Data Ownership Laws

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Bill 7 — DRDO Act Titles I–IV

GP [4/5 — Strong]

EU GDPR (2018) establishes fiduciary-standard data protection with documented compliance effects: documented reduction in data broker activity, behavioral changes in platform consent architecture; California CCPA/CPRA, UK GDPR, Canada PIPEDA, Japan APPI, South Korea PIPA all provide national frameworks.

Sources: 131, 138

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Federal data privacy legislation stalled 10+ years; but bipartisan agreement on need for federal standard increased post-Loper Bright (2024) given weakened Chevron deference making rulemaking less reliable; Bill 7/DRDO provides statutory framework with FTC enforcement; 60-vote threshold; 3–5 year compliance infrastructure buildout.

Sources: 131, 138, 293

B [5/5 — Critical]

Data extraction harms documented: manipulative advertising targeting vulnerable populations, discriminatory algorithmic decision-making in housing and credit, surveillance enabling IPV; harm concentration in lower-income, lower-education, and minority populations; baseline consent and fiduciary protection is foundational to digital participation.

Sources: 131, 138

P23 — Ban Congressional Insider Trading

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title I

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK Parliamentary Standards Act, Canadian MP conflict rules, Australian Ministerial Standards, EU institutional integrity frameworks all restrict official trading and require disclosure; STOCK Act (2012) provides US statutory basis — gap is enforcement, not authority.

Sources: 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Constitutional framework sound (Brewster 1972, Gravel 1972 establish Speech or Debate Clause does not protect securities trading); Bill 3/ACFM strengthens penalties and establishes blind trust requirements beyond STOCK Act; 60-vote threshold; 2022 House-passed bill stalled in Senate demonstrating political headwinds.

Sources: 196, 197

B [4/5 — High]

Members with personal investment in regulated sectors have documented structural conflict of interest; mandatory blind trusts eliminate ongoing conflict; disgorgement and criminal penalties provide deterrence;

democratic legitimacy benefit from eliminating appearance of self-dealing.

Sources: 196, 197

P24 — Higher Standards & Accountability for Officials

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 3 — ACFM Act Titles I-II

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK Bribery Act (2010) strict liability for official corruption; Germany StGB Amtsmissbrauch mandatory penalties; France HATVP mandatory personal asset disclosure; Transparency International Corruption Perceptions Index documents strong correlation between accountability frameworks and lower corruption.

Sources: 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Enhanced criminal penalties for official misconduct require legislation (Bill 3/ACFM); Brewster establishes criminal prosecution does not implicate Speech or Debate Clause for trading conduct; broader constituent and public support than insider trading ban makes political passage more achievable.

Sources: 196, 197

B [4/5 — High]

World Bank Governance Indicators document correlation between rule of law (including official accountability) and economic development, public service delivery quality, and investment; adverse selection reduction (self-interested actors less likely to seek office when consequences are high).

Sources: 197

P25 — Full Financial Transparency for Presidents

GP=3 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 6.7 · Phase I · Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title II

GP [3/5 — Partial]

France HATVP requires full asset disclosure for presidential candidates; Canada ethics commissioner has Prime Ministerial jurisdiction; Germany ministerial disclosure; no peer nation has faced the specific US situation of a president with large, publicly visible private business empire managed while in office.

Sources: 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Trump v. Mazars (2020) established four-factor balancing test; statutory mandatory disclosure as condition of public office is constitutionally distinguishable from subpoena power; Duplantier v. United States (5th Cir. 1979) upheld mandatory disclosure for federal officials; novel Article II questions counsel external legal review before introduction.

Sources: 196

B [4/5 — High]

Documented conflicts in Trump administrations (tariffs, regulatory enforcement, foreign engagement decisions proximate to presidential financial interests); transparency enables Congressional, judicial, and public accountability for apparent conflicts; mechanism is accountability-enabling.

Sources: 197

P26 — Bipartisan Oversight of Detention Facilities

GP=2 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 6.0 · Phase I · Executive — EO + congressional directive

GP [2/5 — Limited]

EU Reception Conditions Directive standards and independent monitoring bodies across member states provide accountability precedent; bipartisan committee structure for detention oversight is structurally novel among Tier 1 comparators whose parliamentary systems provide oversight through different mechanisms.

Sources: 132

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Partial implementation via executive order (mandatory inspection schedules, reporting requirements for privately managed facilities); full statutory bipartisan committee structure requires legislation; DHS rulemaking can establish facility standards within existing authority.

Sources: 132, 195

B [4/5 — High]

DHS OIG (2019–2024) documented inadequate medical care, overcrowding, and in-custody deaths (41 in 2022, highest recorded); ~40,000 individuals in daily detention; facility conditions affect detainee capacity to participate in immigration proceedings with documented case outcome effects.

Sources: 132

P27 — Restrict Corporate Home Ownership

GP=3 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 6.7 · Phase I · Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I

GP [3/5 — Partial]

Canada Prohibition on Purchase by Non-Canadians Act (2023); Australia planning approval requirements; New Zealand Overseas Investment Act (2018 amendments); EU member states emerging restrictions; domestic corporate (vs. foreign) single-family acquisition restrictions are more novel.

Sources: 133, 134

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Bill 8/HCI provides statutory vehicle; Takings Clause and Due Process constraints limit retroactive application but permit prospective prohibition; incentive-based state adoption achievable through reconciliation funding; direct federal prohibition requires 60-vote threshold; private equity real estate lobby significant.

Sources: 133, 134, 196

B [4/5 — High]

Harvard JCHS (2024): 12.1 million renter households severely cost-burdened; institutional investors own up to 40% of single-family rental homes in some submarkets; NLIHC: 7.3M affordable home shortage; corporate ownership displaces first-time buyers from primary wealth-building mechanism.

Sources: 133, 134

P28 — Stricter Advertising Laws

GP=5 · UT=3 · B=3 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 7 — DRDO Act Title II + Title V

v26 revision: *UT: 4 -> 3 (FTC rulemaking timeline evidence insufficient for UT=4). Score: 7.5 -> 7.3.*

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Japan JFTC truth-in-advertising enforcement with documented compliance effects is direct model; UK HFSS ad ban (9pm watershed + 24hr online: enforcement January 2026, estimated 20,000 fewer childhood obesity cases); EU Unfair Commercial Practices Directive; Quebec consumer protection advertising ban (1978, 45+ years of evidence).

Sources: 143, 144, 145

[v26■] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

FTC rulemaking averages 5+ years ANPR-to-final; Click-to-Cancel rule (Oct 2024) was vacated by 8th Circuit (July 8, 2025); Commercial Surveillance ANPR stalled 3.7+ years; statutory authority via Bill 7/DRDO is more durable path; 60-vote threshold; Central Hudson framework permits reasonable restrictions on false/misleading commercial speech.

Sources: 293

[v26■] B [3/5 — Moderate]

Children's advertising restrictions have documented welfare effects (Quebec ban: Dhar-Baylis reduced fast-food purchase propensity 13%/week; Boyland meta-analysis: 96 studies confirm food marketing increases caloric intake); adult truth-in-advertising provides real but diffuse consumer welfare protection; below Moderate because primary mechanism affects a subset of advertising.

Sources: 143, 144, 145

EDUCATION**P34 — Reduce Tuition & Expand Adult Education**

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 4 — FSW Act Title II

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Germany's dual apprenticeship system (50%+ of students, longitudinal employment outcome data: Tier A); Denmark, Finland, Sweden: universal adult vocational retraining programs tied to employment transitions; Germany eliminated university tuition nationally (2014); OECD Education at a Glance documents per-student outcomes.

Sources: 135, 290

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Title IV funding conditions (South Dakota v. Dole constitutional authority) allow federal tuition cap leverage; Tennessee Promise (150,000+ enrolled, \$4,537/student/yr community college, all-time high 83.8% first-to-second semester success in 2024) is strongest US analog; 28 state promise programs confirm scaling model; 5–10 year federal scaling timeline.

Sources: 135, 290, 291

B [4/5 — High]

\$1.7T outstanding student debt; average \$37,000 per graduate; adult vocational retraining directly addresses workforce displacement; Tennessee Promise data: scalable at ~\$4,500/student/yr; burden relief most progressive for graduates from lower-income families with highest debt-to-income ratios.

Sources: 135, 136, 290

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

P38 — Renewable & Nuclear Energy Investment

GP=5 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.7 · Phase I · Bill 2 — IIC Act Titles I & II

GP [5/5 — Proven]

EU Green Deal (€600B, 2021–2030), Germany Energiewende (80% renewable target by 2030), France nuclear fleet (70%+ of electricity), Denmark (50%+ wind generation), Japan Green Transformation; IEA (2024): renewables = 90% of new global electricity capacity additions; solar LCOE declined 90% (2010–2023).

Sources: 26, 34, 35

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Reconciliation vehicle (no 60-vote threshold); IRA (2022) established investment framework — this proposal extends and scales; physical grid constraint: US permitting for major transmission projects averages 7+ years; thorium nuclear carries additional technical uncertainty (no commercial scale deployment in Tier 1 comparators).

Sources: 26, 34, 35

B [5/5 — Critical]

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory (2024): IRA-driven solar/wind now lowest-cost new electricity in most US regions; DOE (2024): 80% clean electricity by 2035 reduces consumer costs up to \$500/household/yr; IRA manufacturing credits support 279,000 jobs by 2030; IPCC AR6: clean energy transition is the single highest-impact climate mitigation pathway.

Sources: 26, 34, 35

P39 — Restore & Expand Federal Inspectors

GP=4 · UT=4 · B=4 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Bill 2 — IIC Act Title IV

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK HSE, Germany Bundesbehörden, France inspection régimes maintain inspector-to-regulated-entity ratios substantially exceeding current US levels; OECD Regulatory Policy Outlook documents peer nations maintain consistent enforcement staffing as core public administration function.

Sources: 5, 195

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

Within executive authority and Bill 2/IIC appropriations authorization; OPM hiring averages 101 days job-announcement to hire; OSHA inspector training ~5 years; pipeline can be launched immediately but operational capacity builds over 3–5 years; Yale Budget Lab: reducing IRS staffing 28,000 increases deficit ~\$600B/10yr — same root cause for inspection capacity erosion.

Sources: 5, 195, 276

B [4/5 — High]

Haviland-Burns-Gray (NBER, 2010): OSHA inspections reduce injuries 9.4% and workers' compensation costs 26% over 4+ years with no employment effect; GAO High Risk List documents inspection capacity gaps across food safety, workplace safety, and environmental enforcement; distributional impact progressive — lower-wage workers in agriculture/construction/food processing bear highest enforcement gap burden.

Sources: 5, 195, 276

P40 — Shoreline & Fishery Protection

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: **7.3** · Phase I · Executive — NOAA/EPA rulemaking

v26 revision: UT: 4 -> 3 (NOAA rulemaking scaling evidence insufficient for UT=4). Score: 8.0 -> 7.3.

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Norway ITQ fishery management system is the international reference for sustainable catch management; EU Common Fisheries Policy with documented stock recovery outcomes; Australia GBRMPA integrated marine protection model; Marine Protected Areas with adequate enforcement show documented biodiversity and catch recovery in adjacent areas.

Sources: 163

[v26■] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

NOAA Status of Stocks (2023): ~2 stock rebuilds/yr since 2000; rebuilding plans typically exceed 10 years for depleted stocks; no NOAA implementation trajectory evidence for reaching 60–90% population within 10 years; seafloor mining moratorium requires executive order (vulnerable to reversal) or legislation; ecological recovery timeline is the binding UT constraint.

Sources: 163

B [4/5 — High]

NOAA: ocean-based industries \$373B to US GDP annually; 46 stocks subject to overfishing or overfished; shoreline ecosystem services (storm surge mitigation, carbon sequestration, wildlife habitat) have documented monetized value; coastal fishing communities bear concentrated economic harm from stock depletion.

Sources: 163

P41 — Strategic Domestic Technology Investment

GP=5 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: **8.7** · Phase I · Bill 2 — IIC Act Title II

GP [5/5 — Proven]

Taiwan TSMC (government-linked public-private semiconductor dominance); South Korea Samsung/SK Hynix state-directed investment; EU Chips Act (2023, €43B); Japan semiconductor reinvestment program; SIA (2021): concentration of advanced semiconductor production in Taiwan is documented supply chain vulnerability.

Sources: 278

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Reconciliation vehicle (extends CHIPS Act framework); primary constraint is physical — semiconductor fab construction takes 5–7 years groundbreaking to production; CHIPS R&D; workforce development requires specialized training pipelines; timeline to meaningful domestic production capacity is at outer edge of Phase I window.

Sources: 278

B [5/5 — Critical]

2021–2022 chip shortage: ~\$240B in lost US manufacturing output (Chicago Fed estimate); contributed to inflation across multiple consumer sectors; battery technology cost reduction accelerates clean energy deployment (P38 compounding effect); domestic capacity reduces adversarial supply chain leverage over defense and consumer technology systems.

Sources: 278

P42 — Cooperative Mining with Allied Nations

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: **7.3** · Phase I · Executive — State Department

GP [4/5 — Strong]

US-Australia Critical Minerals Partnership, EU Critical Raw Materials Act (2023), Japan-Australia critical minerals cooperation, G7 Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment all represent documented allied-nation

supply chain collaboration frameworks with active implementation.

Sources: 196

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Bilateral cooperation agreements within State Department executive authority; major extraction treaty frameworks require Senate two-thirds ratification; partner-nation extraction capacity expansion requires private investment alongside government frameworks; meaningful supply chain diversification takes 7+ years.

Sources: 196

B [4/5 — High]

China dominates processing of cobalt, lithium, and rare earths — strategic leverage over electric vehicles, clean energy systems, and defense electronics; supply chain diversification reduces cost volatility and adversarial leverage; secondary benefit: environmental and labor standard conditions in allied-nation agreements.

Sources: 196

P43 — Modernize Airports & Air Traffic Control

GP=4 · UT=4 · B=3 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 2 — IIC Act Title III

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Germany Fraport, France ADP, Singapore Changi, Japan NARITA demonstrate government-led airport infrastructure excellence; EU SESAR mandates member-state ATC modernization; peer nations maintain lower delay rates and higher efficiency metrics than current US system.

Sources: 146, 195

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

Bill 2/IIC appropriations authorization; FAA statutory authority established; but FAA NextGen program: \$15B+ spent, ~16% of projected benefits delivered as of 2025, completion projected 2030+; UT=4 maintained because legislative/funding mechanism is achievable — implementation constraint is managerial not structural.

Sources: 272, 195

B [3/5 — Moderate]

Primary beneficiaries are frequent air travelers (disproportionately higher-income) and cargo efficiency; FAA documented implementation efficiency problem (16% of NextGen projected benefits delivered) moderates near-term benefit confidence; infrastructure maintenance value is real but welfare distribution is less progressive than most Phase I proposals.

Sources: 272, 195

P44 — Electrify & Modernize USPS

GP=4 · UT=4 · B=3 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 2 — IIC Act Title III

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Germany Deutsche Post DHL, France La Poste, UK Royal Mail all pursuing or achieving partial fleet electrification; Biden EO requiring 100% EV federal vehicle purchases by 2035 established policy direction; USPS NGDV contract with Oshkosh Defense provides implementation framework.

Sources: 273

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

Bill 2/IIC provides appropriations authorization; USPS has statutory authority and began NGDV execution; but USPS NGDV: ~9 years from program initiation to ~2,500 vehicles (Nov 2025, ~3% of fleet), 3× cost estimate; UT=4 maintained because legislative mechanism is clear — pace requires acceleration to achieve meaningful fleet transition within term.

Sources: 273

B [3/5 — Moderate]

USPS fleet electrification reduces long-term operating costs contributing to USPS financial instability; service reliability improvement for rural/elderly/lower-income populations most dependent on USPS for medication, financial correspondence, and package services; emissions reduction and domestic manufacturing employment (NGDV production) are secondary benefits.

Sources: 273

MILITARY & DEFENSE

P46 — Expand Cyberwarfare Defenses

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Executive — DoD/NSA directive

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK NCSC (est. 2016), France ANSSI, Germany BSI, Israel Unit 8200 ecosystem, NATO CCDCOE all represent institutional models with documented offensive and defensive capacity; US CYBERCOM elevated to Unified Combatant Command (2018) provides organizational framework.

Sources: 282

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Expanding CYBERCOM within executive authority; bipartisan NDAA support for cyber provisions; DoD Cyberspace Workforce Strategy 2023–2027: original CMF reached FOC at 133 teams (2018), NDAA FY2022 approved expansion to 147 teams — 12 of 14 new teams established by May 2025; cybersecurity talent gap 750,000+ unfilled positions is the binding UT constraint.

Sources: 282

B [5/5 — Critical]

SolarWinds (2020), Colonial Pipeline (2021), multiple healthcare ransomware events demonstrate cyber vulnerability translates directly to population welfare harm: fuel shortages, medication delivery failures, financial disruptions; all Americans depend on resilient power, water, financial, and healthcare systems; marginal resilience improvement at scale is uniquely high-value.

Sources: 282

P48 — Reinforce War Powers Act

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Executive — Congressional resolution

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK Parliament Vote on Iraq (2003); Germany Bundeswehr Parlamentsbeteiligungsgesetz (2005) requires Bundestag approval for foreign deployments; Netherlands, Denmark, Finland have comparable parliamentary authorization requirements; Watson Institute: \$8T+ post-9/11 operations, none with formal declarations of war.

Sources: 156, 157

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Congressional resolution within Article I authority; Chadha (1983) invalidated legislative veto mechanism; appropriations-conditional authorization is most constitutionally durable path; bipartisan executive resistance consistent across administrations since 1973 is the primary UT barrier; GP corrected to Strong (4) in v25 from prior Partial assessment.

Sources: 157, 196

B [4/5 — High]

\$8T+ spent on unauthorized military engagements with documented humanitarian consequences; military service falls disproportionately on lower-income Americans — accountability for deployment is a distributionally progressive reform; WPR 48-year non-enforcement track record is itself the evidence for legislative reform.

Sources: 156, 157

P49 — Pentagon Budget Audit Accountability

GP=3 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 6.7 · Phase I · Executive — NDAA + IG directive

GP [3/5 — Partial]

UK MOD, German Bundeswehr, French DGA complete annual audits; US DoD is the only major agency of any Tier 1 government to fail annual audits for seven consecutive years (FY2018–FY2024 all disclaimers of opinion, per GAO-25-107427); no direct model for consequences-for-failure because no peer faces this situation.

Sources: 158, 283

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

NDAA provisions establishing IG directives and audit performance requirements achievable through regular authorization; GAO-25-107427 (Sept 2025): 28 material weaknesses persist DoD-wide; Financial Management Systems Modernization remediation slipped from FY2028 to FY2031; statutory mandate: clean audit by December

31, 2028 — trajectory not currently on track.

Sources: 158, 283

B [4/5 — High]

DoD IG (2023): \$247.5M duplicate payments, \$6.8B accounting adjustments without documentation, \$1.9T in assets 'cannot be verified'; consequences-for-failure framework creates incentives for system modernization; fiscal waste captured is directly available for either enhanced defense capacity or domestic investment.

Sources: 158, 283

P50 — Reduce Military Contractor Dependence

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Executive — DoD procurement reform

GP [4/5 — Strong]

UK MOD, German Bundeswehr, French Armée all maintain significantly higher ratios of direct government employment to contractors for non-combat functions; RAND defense studies document 1.3–1.5× cost premium for contractor provision of comparable non-combat functions; Quincy/Brown: contractors received 54% of \$4.4T Pentagon budget 2020–2024.

Sources: 148, 149

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

DoD procurement reform within executive authority for most contracting and employment decisions; major LOGCAP framework changes require NDAA action; defense contractor industry lobby (Lockheed, Raytheon, General Dynamics, KBR) significant; 3–5 year transition timeline for structured conversion programs.

Sources: 148, 149, 150

B [4/5 — High]

Commission on Wartime Contracting (2011): \$31–60B lost to contractor fraud and waste in Iraq and Afghanistan alone; contractor premium 1.3–1.5× over direct employment for non-combat functions represents recoverable fiscal waste; direct government employment provides better benefits and career paths for equivalent roles.

Sources: 148, 149

AGRICULTURE & ENVIRONMENT

P53 — Water Rights & Foreign Ownership Ban

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Australia FIRB evaluates all significant foreign water rights acquisitions; EU Water Framework Directive establishes water as public good; Chile Constitutional debate (2022) centered on water rights reallocation; GAO (2024): 43.4 million acres of US agricultural land under foreign ownership, up 66% over a decade.

Sources: 160

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

CFIUS authority exists for national security review of water-adjacent agricultural land; primary gap is state-level framework consistency and national ownership registry; Bill 8/HCI provides federal model legislation; 60-vote threshold for statutory registry; water rights law is primarily state-administered requiring model legislation adoption pathway.

Sources: 160, 196

B [5/5 — Critical]

Water access is foundational to agricultural production, municipal supply, and regional economic viability; water is a non-reproducible resource in water-scarce regions; foreign acquisition permanently reduces US strategic flexibility; GAO: foreign ownership of agricultural land up 66% in a decade; distributional impact universal — water security is foundational physical welfare.

Sources: 160

P54 — Domestic Food Priority Laws

GP=3 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 6.7 · Phase I · Executive — USDA rulemaking

v26 revision: *UT: 4 -> 3 (USDA rulemaking scaling evidence insufficient). B: 4 -> 3.7. Score: 7.5 -> 6.7.*

GP [3/5 — Partial]

EU export restriction powers exist for crisis situations (food security emergency provisions); some middle-income agricultural exporters use domestic supply priority requirements as standard regulation; direct Tier 1 comparator precedent at US agricultural scale is limited — GP=3 reflects partial comparability.

Sources: 162, 63

[v26■] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

USDA rulemaking under Agricultural Marketing Act provides primary vehicle; but USDA REAP frozen by executive order (2025), demonstrating executive vulnerability of USDA programmatic food policy; no US implementation study found for food supply chain intervention at required scale; WTO Agricultural Agreement constraints on domestic supply priority requirements add legal complexity.

Sources: 63, 280

B [4/5 — High]

USDA ERS (2024): 12.8% of US households (17M) experienced food insecurity in 2023; US is world's largest food exporter despite this rate; FAO: countries with domestic food security buffers have 23% lower acute food insecurity during commodity price shocks; food price stabilization is most progressive in distributional impact (lower-income households spend higher income share on food).

Sources: 63, 162

P55 — Protect Marine Life & Expand Aquaculture

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: **8.0** · Phase I · Executive — NOAA rulemaking

v26 revision: UT: 4 -> 3 (NOAA aquaculture scaling evidence insufficient for UT=4). Score: 9.0 -> 8.0.

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Norway is global leader in sustainable salmon aquaculture (government investment, research partnerships, regulatory frameworks); Australia GBRMPA integrated marine protection model; Japan and South Korea government-supported aquaculture scaling; NOAA: ocean-based industries contribute \$373B to US GDP annually.

Sources: 162, 163

[v26■] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

NOAA rulemaking authority under Magnuson-Stevens is the primary vehicle; but NOAA Aquaculture Strategic Plan 2023–2028 contains NO quantitative production target; US ranks 17th–18th globally in aquaculture production with <1% of global output; 2016–2020 +50% target was missed and abandoned; seafloor mining moratorium is reversible without statutory protection.

Sources: 163

B [5/5 — Critical]

[v26■ B revised from 5 to ≈4.5] Aquaculture now accounts for 57% of seafood for human consumption globally (FAO); marine protection provides ecosystem services (storm surge mitigation, carbon sequestration); coastal fishing communities bear concentrated economic harm from stock depletion; benefit is high but trajectory uncertainty from NOAA's demonstrated implementation gap moderates score from Critical to just below.

Sources: 162, 163

P56 — Subsidize Agricultural Electrification

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: **7.3** · Phase I · Executive — USDA/DOE grants

GP [4/5 — Strong]

EU Common Agricultural Policy includes green investment requirements; Germany and Netherlands agricultural electrification programs; IRA (2022) USDA REAP established US framework; OECD documents peer nations investing in agricultural energy transition as standard practice.

Sources: 280

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

USDA/DOE grant authority provides implementation vehicle; REAP freeze (2025) demonstrates statutory protection needed for durability; farm equipment replacement cycle (10–15 years per machine) limits electrification pace regardless of subsidy availability; rural EV charging infrastructure is nascent; 5–10 year meaningful fleet transition.

Sources: 280

B [4/5 — High]

Electric agricultural equipment operating costs lower than diesel equivalents long-term; rural agricultural communities bear disproportionate air quality costs from diesel equipment; USDA/DOE modeling documents emissions and cost-reduction trajectory; distributional benefit most progressive for family farms (less access to capital for equipment transitions).

Sources: 280

P57 — Address Farm Labor Abuses

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Executive — DOL enforcement

GP [4/5 — Strong]

EU Seasonal Workers Directive (2014) and member-state enforcement; Canada SAWP with federal oversight; Australia Fair Work Act agricultural coverage — all provide documented frameworks with enforcement outcomes; US FLSA and MSPA (1983) provide statutory authority — gap is enforcement capacity.

Sources: 169

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

DOL Wage and Hour Division (WHD) enforcement capacity expansion within executive authority; WHD inspector staffing at historically low levels relative to regulated workforce; H-2A agricultural guest worker program creates parallel channel complicating enforcement; 1-3 year timeline for meaningfully expanded agricultural enforcement presence.

Sources: 169, 195

B [4/5 — High]

~2.4M agricultural workers including ~70% undocumented status (least able to report violations); EPI (2022): systematic wage theft estimated at billions annually; documented physical risks (heat illness, pesticide exposure, housing deficiency); enforcement directly transfers income from violating employers to workers — strongly progressive distributional impact.

Sources: 169

P58 — Break Up Agricultural Monopolies

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Bill 3 — ACFM Act Title III

GP [4/5 — Strong]

EU blocking of Bayer-Monsanto (2018) with structural remedy conditions; Packers and Stockyards Act authority for DOJ/USDA enforcement; Biden DOJ agriculture-specific antitrust enforcement increase (2021-2024); documented correlation between agricultural consolidation and input price increases.

Sources: 66, 163

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Bill 3/ACFM applies repeat-violator criminal liability to agricultural sector; Packers and Stockyards Act enforcement within executive priority directive; ADM, Cargill, Tyson, JBS, Deere have significant Congressional relationships particularly in Senate agricultural states; multi-year enforcement timeline for structural market change.

Sources: 66, 196

B [4/5 — High]

Agricultural consolidation imposes welfare costs on both sides: farmers face monopsony (fewer buyers, lower prices), consumers face oligopoly (fewer sellers, higher food costs); AAI documents price-cost margin expansion following consolidation; distributional impact progressive — family farmers and lower-income food consumers bear highest burden.

Sources: 66, 68

P59 — National Climate Preparedness Corps

GP=3 · UT=4 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Executive — FEMA/EPA reorganization

GP [3/5 — Partial]

Germany Technisches Hilfswerk (THW), Japan Cabinet Office Disaster Management, Netherlands Delta Programme for proactive climate infrastructure hardening; EU Civil Protection Mechanism; but integrated proactive-reactive climate response under unified mandate is novel design.

Sources: 285

UT [4/5 — Achievable]

President's Reorganization Authority allows agency restructuring with congressional notification; ACC (launched Sept 2023, claimed 15,000 members by Sept 2024) demonstrates corps scaling capacity; ACC termination by EO (Jan 20, 2025) demonstrates reversal risk — statutory framework essential; FEMA/EPA institutional coordination complexity manageable within executive authority; UT=4 maintained with durability caveat.

Sources: 285

B [5/5 — Critical]

NOAA documents weather/climate disasters (\$1B+ damage) increased from 7.9/yr (1980–2022 avg) to 18/yr (recent 5-year period); climate welfare burden falls disproportionately on lower-income communities with less adaptive capacity; proactive preparedness (environmental monitoring, infrastructure hardening, coordinated response) reduces both frequency and severity of welfare harm; population affected is universal.

Sources: 285

FOREIGN AFFAIRS & IMMIGRATION

P62 — Diplomatic Relationship Restoration & Strategic Investment

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=5 · Score: 8.0 · Phase I · Executive — State Department

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Post-Cold War German reunification diplomacy, post-Vietnam US diplomatic repair (1970s), Obama-era JCPOA negotiation — all document structured diplomatic restoration with measurable economic and security outcome improvements; G7 Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment provides current allied development partnership model.

Sources: 196

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

Alliance re-engagement within executive authority — Day 1 executable; rejoining multilateral frameworks (Paris Agreement re-accession procedurally available) is near-immediate; but substantive relationships require sustained institutional behavior over multiple years; adversarial normalization (China, Russia) requires sustained engagement not reducible to Day 1 action; 1–3 year timeline for allied repair, longer for adversarial normalization.

Sources: 196

B [5/5 — Critical]

US diplomatic relationships underpin multilateral frameworks governing trade, security, technology, and climate; documented allied relationship disruption imposed costs on export market access, security cooperation, pandemic preparedness, and international rules-based order; effective diplomacy is the infrastructure for every dimension of international welfare that affects American living standards and security.

Sources: 196

P63 — Selective & Streamlined Immigration Policy

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=4 · Score: 7.3 · Phase I · Executive — DHS/DOS rulemaking

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Canada Express Entry (points-based with fast processing), Australia skilled migration framework, Germany Fachkräfteeinwanderungsgesetz (2020) — all combine tighter admissions criteria with cleaner, faster citizenship pathways and documented economic integration outcomes.

Sources: 196, 197

UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

DHS and DOS have significant regulatory authority within INA statutory framework; processing efficiency improvements (digitization, adjudicator staffing, asylum court capacity) within executive authority; structural visa system reform requires 60-vote threshold; USCIS backlogs exceeded 10M applications (2024); 3–5 year administrative modernization timeline.

Sources: 196, 197

B [4/5 — High]

USCIS backlog >10M applications creates legal limbo harm for immigrants and employer productivity loss; cleaner citizenship pathways reduce social exclusion and improve long-term integration outcomes; Canada and Australia demonstrate that structured systems produce superior economic integration outcomes relative to US current system; points-based selection improves labor market match quality.

Sources: 196, 197

P64 — International Property Ownership Framework

GP=4 · UT=3 · B=3 · Score: **6.7** · Phase I · Bill 8 — HCI Act Title I

v26 revision: UT: 4 -> 3 (HCI Act federal leverage scaling evidence insufficient). Score: 7.0 -> 6.7.

GP [4/5 — Strong]

Australia FIRB restricts all significant foreign real estate acquisitions; Canada Investment Canada Act reviews agricultural land acquisitions; New Zealand Overseas Investment Act (2018 amendments) restricts foreign residential and agricultural purchases; GAO (2024): foreign agricultural land ownership up 66% in a decade.

Sources: 160, 281

[v26■] UT [3/5 — Moderate Difficulty]

CFIUS CY2024: reviewed 325 covered transactions, issued 5 civil penalties (record, largest at \$60M) — but narrow scope confirms UT cannot support broad policy coverage claim; no implementation study found for federal model legislation at scale; 50-state adoption through incentive mechanism adds implementation complexity.

Sources: 160, 281

B [3/5 — Moderate]

[v26■ B revised downward] Foreign acquisition of residential and agricultural property creates documented local welfare concerns (housing affordability, food security) but affects a meaningful subset rather than dominant share of total property transactions; CFIUS 325 transactions/yr vs. millions of total US property transactions illustrates current narrow reach; indirect welfare mechanism earns B≈3.2 rather than B=3 or B=4.

Sources: 160, 281

REF_RDNC_ScoringJustification_2026_SectionA — Framework v26 · Scoring Methodology v1.1 · Source Reference Guide v11 · Internal Reference — Not for Distribution · Reform Democrats of the New Commonwealth · Project ARA 2028 · May 2026. All scores carry an estimated +/-1 margin of subjectivity. Developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). The ideas belong to anyone willing to fight for them.
